

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Dheepa Wijayasingam

Address: 7 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing as a resident who lives very close to the proposed development site. My family and I pass through this area several times every day, and I feel strongly that the practical impact of this proposal on daily life in our neighbourhood has not been fully appreciated.

While I understand the importance of community facilities, I have serious concerns about the consequences this development would have on road safety, congestion, noise, and the overall character of our residential area.

First and foremost, traffic is already a significant issue. The roads surrounding the site regularly become congested, particularly because of Avenue Primary Academy, which has over 1,000 pupils. During school drop-off and pick-up times, the area becomes a bottleneck. It can take several minutes just to pass through a short stretch of road due to parked cars, vehicles manoeuvring, and heavy pedestrian movement.

Adding an estimated 70-80 vehicles during peak times, particularly where arrivals and departures overlap, would inevitably worsen this congestion. The cumulative effect would not just be inconvenience - it could create dangerous conditions. Increased vehicle circulation, informal parking, and cars searching for spaces would significantly heighten the risk to children and pedestrians.

Of particular concern is emergency access. When the road is already gridlocked at school times, it is difficult to see how ambulances or other emergency vehicles would be able to pass through quickly. This raises genuine health and safety concerns for residents.

In addition, the proposed capacity of up to 250 people, with activity potentially continuing until around 11PM, would introduce a level of late-evening noise and disturbance that is entirely different from the current character of the area. The dispersal of large groups, raised voices, car doors slamming, engines idling, and vehicles circulating in search of parking spaces would

significantly affect the quiet enjoyment of neighbouring homes.

There are also vulnerable and elderly residents living nearby who may be particularly impacted by increased noise and ongoing disturbance.

Finally, the scale and visual presence of the proposed building appear out of keeping with the surrounding residential properties. The development feels disproportionate to the character of the area and would dominate what is currently a relatively low-key neighbourhood setting.

For all of these reasons - traffic congestion, school safety, emergency access concerns, noise disturbance, impact on vulnerable residents, and harm to the character of the area - I respectfully ask that the Council refuse this application.

Thank you for taking the time to consider the views of local residents.